

RETCON

Team APEX • Game Jam: Comic + Twist + Light

One-line pitch: RETCON is a comic-book puzzle-platformer where narration captions are your controls. Swap words such as NIGHT to DAY and the world rewrites itself so you can reach the exit.

1. Concept

The hero lives inside a comic page. Each level begins with a narrator caption like "The sky was [NIGHT] and the bridge was [BROKEN]." Click the bracketed words to cycle alternatives; the level changes instantly. Then run and jump to the exit. The player does not fight the villain — they edit the story until the villain cannot win.

2. How we use each theme

Theme	Implementation
Comic	Comic-page layout, thick ink outlines, halftone shading, caption boxes, speech bubbles and POW/BAM effects. The caption is part of gameplay.
Light	NIGHT / DAY / SUNSET changes the world: night spawns shadow beasts, day melts ice and dissolves shadows, while sunset creates safe shadow platforms.
Twist	The narrator can rewrite its own words mid-level. The final level reveals that the narrator is the villain.

3. Core gameplay loop

1. Read the caption and inspect the level. 2. Click words to rewrite the world. 3. Run/jump to the exit. 4. Adapt when the narrator twist triggers. 5. Reach the exit to turn the page.

Controls: A/D or arrows = move • Space = jump • Mouse = click words • R = restart.

4. Rule system

Every word is a tag and objects react through simple rules. Examples: ice + day → melts; shadow + day → dissolves. Example puzzle: [NIGHT/DAY/SUNSET] + [BROKEN/ICE/STONE]. Solutions include STONE + DAY, STONE + SUNSET and ICE + SUNSET; ICE + DAY melts the bridge and NIGHT summons a beast.

5. Scope

10–12 short levels (~1 minute each) + final boss-twist level.

~10 words/tags; target playtime 10–15 minutes.

Win by reaching the exit; falling/caught/narrator undo = instant retry.

Working HTML prototype demonstrates word swapping, light changes and comic presentation.

6. Technology

HTML5 + JavaScript + Phaser 3 (Arcade Physics), bundled with Vite. Hosted on GitHub Pages / itch.io. Git + GitHub for collaboration.

7. Art and audio plan

Art: flat colors, thick outlines, halftone overlays, hand-drawn SVG/PNG captions and bubbles; palette changes with light.

Audio: jsfxr/Bfxr SFX, short jazzy/noir loop and comic sound-effect popups.

Juice: screen shake, page-turn transitions and particles when the world rewrites.

8. Team

Name / Role	Gmail	IndieConnect ID	Responsibility
Sai Ram — Team Leader	thannerusairam9@gmail.com	sairam	Lead programmer: gameplay, tag/rule engine, repo
Sri Vignesh Arya — Team Member	srivignesharya@gmail.com	srivignesharya	Level design, UI, playtesting
Jaswanth Charry — Team Member 2	jashwanthchary28@gmail.com	jaswanthchary28	Art, audio, itch.io, proposal/README

9. Timeline (100 hours)

Hours	Milestone
0–10	Repo, Phaser setup, movement, first word-swap level
10–30	Rule engine, 4 playable levels, fun-check
30–55	All words/levels, narrator twist, final level
55–75	Final art/audio/UI polish; feature freeze ~60h
75–90	Playtesting, balancing, bug fixing
90–100	Deploy, cover, description, buffer

10. Risks and mitigation

Level design: reserve ~20 hours and playtest early.

Scope creep: cap the word list at ~10; feature freeze at hour 60.

Unclear puzzles: hints and instant restart keep the game friendly.

PROTOTYPE MOCKUPS

RETCON prototype screenshots / visual references

